

Q Please tell us a little about your own introduction to the world of open source and your journey so far in this domain.

I was introduced to open source software by a friend while I was a university student. The more I looked at it, the more I found I was able to use it to solve various problems. Later on I learned more about the philosophy of free software and the principles of open source.

Q When did you join Red Hat and what kind of projects have you worked on there?

I joined Red Hat in July 2010. My job at Red Hat is to lead the Fedora community. On a day-by-day basis that means making sure that Fedora is advancing forward, ensuring that communications are strong between the various groups within Fedora, helping to mediate when conflicts happen, and making sure that Red Hat continues to give the Fedora community the respect and resources it deserves.

I act as a conduit between the Fedora Community and Red Hat to make sure that both sides understand the other's concerns.

Q What has your contribution been to the Fedora Project?

I've been a user of Fedora since it split from Red Hat Linux but it wasn't until the past four years or so that I really started to become an active contributor. Most of my early contributions were the testing of pre-releases and bug reporting. Then I joined the Fedora Documentation Team and helped out with writing documentation, improving the work-flow, and helping the team move to newer tools. I have helped to set up some VoIP services for Fedora. I've also spoken at various Fedora events on a range of topics.

Q As the project leader, what are the key goals that you have set for the project and what kind of best practices have you brought into the product development cycle?

As the Fedora Project Leader, I've tried to focus on what is of the most strategic importance to the project. I've worked with the Fedora Board to create a vision statement for our project, which is:

"The Fedora Project creates a world where free culture is welcoming and widespread, collaboration is common-place, and people control their content and devices."

Our vision statement sets our long-term intentions for the project, but we also have short-term goals we're working on as well. We're focused on making the communications within our community better, as well as making the Fedora community a more welcoming environment for those who might be joining us for the first time.

Q What are the significant recent developments in the Fedora project?

Fedora continues to be a pioneer in technical innovation. Each release brings the latest of what's new in free and open source

software. Fedora 16 delivers the latest GNOME 3.2 desktop environment (with several alternative desktops available as well), better integration with the *systemd* initialisation system, several updated tools for virtualization and cloud computing, as well as technical previews of the BTRFS filesystem and Java 7.

We've also made developments on the human side of our community. We continue to increase the number of Fedora events held every year, including our Fedora Activity Days (known as FADs) and our Fedora User and Developers' Conference (known as FUDCon). This year we've had four FUDCon events—one in North America in January, one in Latin America in May, one in Europe in October, and one in India, in November.

In addition to FUDCons and FADs, we've had Fedora Ambassadors represent Fedora at dozens of events around the globe.

Q It has been reported that Fedora 16 "...has better offerings, benefits and technology than Fedora 15, which was released 6 months ago." Could you tell us what is 'better' in Fedora 16?

Fedora 15 shipped with the GNOME 3.0 desktop, which while innovative, still had a few rough edges. Fedora 16 ships with the GNOME 3.2 desktop, which offers quite a number of improvements over the earlier version, including online accounts, a new contact manager, and a new document manager. It also offers a new on-screen keyboard.

In addition to the desktop changes, we've also updated a number of internal items in Fedora 16. For example, in Fedora 15 we moved to the *systemd* initialisation system, but it wasn't running very many of the services using native *systemd* unit files. In Fedora 16, converted the majority of the core services to using native *systemd* configuration files.

Q Red Hat stated that, "India is a hot-bed for open source community development, and is second only to the USA in open source contributions to the Fedora project." Please share a few specific details on the quality of contributions and other observations regarding the Indian community that contributes to the Fedora project.

Our user and contributor base in the Indian subcontinent is very active in Fedora and continues to grow and develop at an amazing pace. In November, we held a Fedora Users' and Developers' Conference in Pune, India and had over 500 attendees, making this the largest conference ever.

Fedora contributors from India help in all aspects of the development process, including writing code, packaging software, testing, writing documentation, doing translation and internationalisation, artwork and design, and marketing.

Q Based on your experience and interaction with the Indian community, what are your observations related to India's FOSS ecosystem?

From what I've observed during my time here, India